Muncie Policy Memo

# Civic Meeting Report

# Muncie Fire Merit Commission October 8, 2026

| Meeting Metadata | Details |
|---|---|
| **Video Recording** | https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mGS1hOOXstw |
| **Publication Date** | 2026-10-08T22:18:20Z |
| **Target Category** | muncie_city |

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# Meeting Summary Report: Muncie Fire Merit Commission

## 2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The regular meeting of the Muncie Fire Merit Commission was called to order at 00:00:00 in October 2026.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Members Present:** Commissioner Cooley, Commissioner Rose, Commissioner Gray, and Commissioner Whited. (Note: Commissioner Dale's presence is noted as absent/not present during roll call, though later referenced).
  - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named by title in the opening roll call, but leading the proceedings.
  - **Additional Officials:** Chief Berford, Attorney Mark Irvin. (Recording secretary Miss White was absent for the evening).

## 3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None explicitly recorded in the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:**

- *Item:* Approval of minutes from the September 10th, 2026 regular meeting.
- *Action & Vote Disposition:* Moved by Vice President/Commissioner Gray and seconded by Commissioner Cooley. Approved by Voice Vote.

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## 4. Substantive Business & Board Action

### 00:01:14 Separation of Probationary Firefighter

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Berford
- **Deliberation Summary:** Based on information shared during a prior executive session, Chief Berford requested that the commission confirm his recommendation to separate probationary firefighter Nicholas Golden from employment with the Muncie Fire Department, pursuant to Indian law and commission rules governing probationary employment.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Moved by Commissioner Rose (and additionally noted by Commissioner Cooley), roll call vote conducted. Approved.

### 00:03:10 Conditional Offer of Employment (Recruit List)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Berford
- **Deliberation Summary:** Opening up a spot due to the separation of the probationary firefighter, the chief requested the commission provide the next three eligible names on the recruit list (Travis Sutherland, Jonathan Powell, and Cole Gearing) and recommended that Travis Sutherland be given a conditional offer of employment.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Moved by Commissioner Gray, seconded by Commissioner Whited. Roll call vote conducted. Approved.

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## 5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- 00:10:00 The presiding officer opened the floor for any public comments or items brought before the commission. No members of the public stepped forward to speak.

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## 6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
  - **Training & Certifications:** Chief Berford highlighted thousands of hours of training and certifications achieved by department personnel, detailed in the back of the meeting packet.

    - **Disciplinary Hearing:** Attorney Mark Irvin announced that a disciplinary matter (referenced as “25 days of one”) has been set for a hearing on November 11th at 5:00 PM, to be conducted as a closed executive session barring any changes.
    - **Annual Award Presentation:** The commission presented the annual **Denise Moore Servant Leadership / Stewardship Award** (honoring the late Denise Moore, long-time trustee office worker and commission member, joined by retired battalion chief Terry Moore) to **Firefighter Matthew Reese** for his extensive volunteerism, recruit academy instruction, continuing education efforts, and apparatus/facility maintenance.
- **Adjournment:**
    - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Motion to adjourn made and seconded from the floor. Approved by Voice Vote.

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